The PrepVault Crisis Binder

Household Preparedness Workbook

Survival planning that works when nothing else does. Encrypted. Offline. No cloud dependency.

Build it once. Review it quarterly. Update it after every near-miss.

Why this binder

Most emergency plans live in a person's head, a notebook, or a cloud app. When the grid goes down, so does the cloud — and so does the app that needed a connection to be useful.

This workbook puts your plan where it still works: on paper you control, plus an encrypted offline digital copy you keep yourself. The strongest crisis binders share the same shape, and this one is built that way:

- **Dual format** — printable, waterproof-friendly pages plus an encrypted offline digital copy
- **Fill-in worksheets**, not static lists — the plan is the blank you actually complete
- **An update cadence** — quarterly, and after every near-miss or life change
- **Per-section ownership** — someone in charge of every section, with an alternate

Fill in every field. If a section doesn't apply to your household, write **N/A** and date it, so it's clear it was considered and skipped on purpose. Then tell your household where the binder lives and who the out-of-area contact is.

How to assemble your binder

- **Print two copies.** One stays in the home. One lives off-site — in a go-bag, vehicle, or outbuilding — so a plan survives even if the house doesn't.
- **Protect the paper.** Use sheet protectors in a 3-ring binder, or print on waterproof paper. Keep the off-site copy in a waterproof pouch.
- **Build the digital copy.** After the paper is filled in, create an encrypted offline copy (Section 9). The cloud is optional. An encrypted local copy is not.
- **Assign owners.** Complete the Ownership page on the next sheet. Every section gets a primary and an alternate.
- **Set the cadence.** Put a quarterly review in your calendar now. Also review within a week of any move, medical change, major purchase, or near-miss.
- **Tell your people.** Household members and your out-of-area contact should know where the binder is and who holds the digital copy.

Contents

#	Section	Owner	Alternate
1	Household Roster & Personal Records		
2	Communication Plan		
3	Medical		
4	Home & Property		
5	Supplies Inventory		
6	Roles & Team		

#	Section	Owner	Alternate
	Coordination		
7	Crisis Quick-Reference		
8	Financial & Legal Records		
9	Digital Backup & Security		
10	Update Log		

Copy this contents page and keep it at the front of the binder. Fill in owners as you complete each section.

Section 1 — Household Roster & Personal Records

Purpose: Every member of the household, what identifies them, and where their critical documents live.

Owner: _____ Alternate: _____

Who's in the household

Name	Date of birth	Blood type	Known conditions	Allergies	Emergency contact

Include everyone who lives in the home, plus anyone with a key who needs to be accounted for in an emergency. Add pets and livestock on the last row of this page if space allows.

Critical documents — where are the originals?

Store originals in a fireproof and waterproof box or safe, and note the location here. Record the document, not the number you'd rather not write down — this page should be useful to a family member, not just to you.

Document	Have it?	Location of original	Copy in binder?
Birth certificates	☐		☐
Passports	☐		☐
Social Security cards	☐		☐
Marriage / divorce records	☐		☐
Citizenship / naturalization papers	☐		☐
Military records	☐		☐

Document	Have it?	Location of original	Copy in binder?
Vehicle titles & registrations	☐		☐
Property deed / lease	☐		☐
Wills & trusts	☐		☐
Insurance policies	☐		☐
Pet registrations / vet records	☐		☐

Section 2 — Communication Plan

Purpose: How your household finds each other and checks in when phones and local lines fail.

Owner: _____ Alternate: _____

Out-of-area contact

Choose one person outside your region. When local lines fail, everyone in the household calls or messages this person — they can relay that everyone is safe. Agree on this in advance and put it in everyone's phone.

Field	Details
Name	
Phone	
Location	
Relation to household	
Do they know they're the contact?	☐ Yes ☐ No — tell them

Local emergency numbers (these are non-emergency lines — call them before you need them)

Service	Number
Police / Sheriff (non-emergency)	
Fire (non-emergency)	
Utilities — electric	
Utilities — gas	
Utilities — water	
Poison control	
Nearest hospital / ER	
Household out-of-area contact	(see above)

Meeting places

Agree on three and make sure every capable member of the household knows them.

- **Inside the home** — (e.g., safe room, basement corner): _____
- **Outside the home, in the neighborhood** — (e.g., mailbox, corner lot): _____
- **Out of the area / rally point** — (e.g., relative's house, community center): _____

Phone tree — who tells whom, in order. Write names and numbers.

- _____ → 2. _____ → 3. _____ → 4. _____

Radio & alternate comms (for households that run radios or plan for full comms failure)

Field	Details
Household radio / call signs	
Primary frequency / channel	
Alternate frequency / channel	
Check-in schedule	(e.g., every morning at 08:00)
Backup comms method	(e.g., text, ham, GMRS, messenger)

Household comms rule: If local lines fail, we will reach each other via: _____

Section 3 — Medical

Purpose: What each person needs medically, what they take, and where to find care and records fast.

Owner: _____ **Alternate:** _____

Household medical worksheet — one row per person

Name	Blood type	Allergies	Chronic conditions	Medications (name, dose, how taken)	Doctor / pharmacy

Medical devices & power needs — anything in the home that needs electricity

Device / equipment	Who uses it	Power/ battery needs	Backup plan if power is out

Providers & insurance

Field	Details
Primary care doctor	

Field	Details
Dentist	
Pharmacy	
Nearest urgent care	
Nearest ER	
Health insurance company / policy #	
Prescription refill number / provider	

Medication checklist

- ☐ Medication list is current and legible
- ☐ A printed copy lives in the go-bag / get-home bag
- ☐ An encrypted digital copy is in the backup (Section 9)
- ☐ At least 7 days (ideally 30) of each essential medication is on hand
- ☐ Refill dates are on the household calendar

Pets / livestock medical

Animal	Vet / large-animal vet	Medications	Needs in an emergency

Section 4 — Home & Property

Purpose: Know your utilities, heat, power, and water — and exactly where to turn things off and on.

Owner: _____ Alternate: _____

Utilities

Utility	Provider	Outage / report number	Shut-off location	Notes
Electric			Breaker panel:	
Gas			Main valve + wrench kept at:	Shut off only if you suspect a leak
Water (city / municipal)			Main shut-off:	
Well (if applicabl	—	—	Pump control:	Pump needs power — see

Utility	Provider	Outage / report number	Shut-off location	Notes
e)				backup below
Septic (if applicable)	—	—	—	

Heating

Heat source	Type / fuel	Where fuel is stored	How much on hand	Refill / rotate date
Primary				
Secondary				

Power

Power source	Type	Fuel / capacity	Runtime estimate	How it connects	Notes
Generator					
Solar / inverter					
Battery bank					
Backup heat (if separate)					

Water

Source	Storage (gallons)	Last refreshed	Backup source	Access notes
Stored water				
Well / spring				
Rain catchment				
Other (pond, creek,				

Source	Storage (gallons)	Last refreshed	Backup source	Access notes
pool)				

If the power is out, list which of the above stop working and what replaces them: _____

Property map notes

PrepVault keeps a pin-based map of your property. Sketch the same key points here so the paper copy stands alone:

Point	What it is	Location on property
Rally point		
Cache / supply stash		
Known hazard		
Evacuation route out		
Shelter (tornado / storm)		

Household special needs — mobility, medical, or anyone who needs extra time or help evacuating:

Person	Need	Who helps them

Section 5 — Supplies Inventory

Purpose: Know what you have, how much, where it is, and when it expires — on paper, and current.

Owner: _____ Alternate: _____

Your coverage targets. Decide these with the household and write them here. PrepVault tracks the same numbers as a live score — power hours, water days, heat days, and food days — so use the same targets in both places.

Life support	Target
Power	___ hours backup
Water	___ days
Heat	___ days
Food	___ days

How to use these sheets

- One row per item. Mark the quantity in units that make sense (gallons, days, cans, cords).
- **Write the expiry or refresh date** on every row. Rotate on a first-in, first-out basis: new stock goes to the back, oldest to the front.
- Update a section whenever it changes materially, and log it in Section 10.
- The paper binder is the durable copy. PrepVault is the live, searchable one — keep both current and

they back each other up.

Water

Item	Quantity	Unit	Location	Last refreshed / expiry	Notes
Bottled water		gallons			
5-gallon jugs / barrels		gallons			
Water filtration / purification		—			
Water treatment tablets		—			

Food — pantry and daily-use

Item	Quantity	Unit	Location	Expiry	Notes
Canned goods		cans			
Shelf-stable staples (rice, beans, pasta, oats)		lbs/days			
Canned proteins		cans			
Infant / special diet items					
Cooking fuel / stove					

Food — long-term storage

Item	Quantity	Unit	Location	Expiry	Notes
Freeze-dried / MREs		servings			
Bulk grains / legumes		lbs			
Seeds (garden)		packets			

Item	Quantity	Unit	Location	Expiry	Notes
Other					

Medical & first aid

Item	Quantity	Location	Expiry	Notes
First-aid kit				
Prescription medications (days on hand)				
Over-the-counter (pain, fever, allergy, stomach)				
Bandages / wound care				
Thermometer / gloves / masks				
Water purification				

Power & batteries

Item	Quantity	Location	Charge / expiry	Notes
Power bank(s)				
Batteries (sizes: AA, AAA, C, D, 9V)				
Generator fuel (gallons, stabilized)				
Fuel for vehicle / heating				
Flashlights / headlamps				
Solar charger				

Lighting & cooking

Item	Quantity	Location	Fuel / notes
Flashlights / headlamps			
Candles /			

Item	Quantity	Location	Fuel / notes
lanterns			
Camp stove / grill + fuel			
Manual can opener			

Sanitation & hygiene

Item	Quantity	Location	Expiry	Notes
Toiletries (soap, toothpaste, deodorant)				
Toilet paper / wipes				
Trash bags				
Hand sanitizer / soap				
Feminine products / diapers				

Clothing & warmth

Item	Quantity	Location	Notes
Blankets / sleeping bags			
Warm layers per person			
Rain gear			
Work gloves / sturdy footwear			

Comms & electronics

Item	Quantity	Location	Notes
Radios (ham/ GMRS)			
Battery-powered / crank radio			
Weather radio			
Spare chargers			

Cash & important papers

Item	Amount / location	Notes
Cash on hand (small bills)		
Spare credit/ debit cards		
Passport / ID copies		

Bags & tools

Item	Location	Ready?
Go-bag / bug-out bag (per person)		☐
Get-home bag (per vehicle)		☐
Tools (multi-tool, wrench for gas shut-off, axe)		☐
Duct tape, rope/ paracord, zip ties		☐
Fire extinguisher(s) — check pressure		☐

Defense & security (if applicable to your household)

Item	Quantity	Location	Notes
Firearms / ammunition			Store per your household rules
Pepper spray / deterrents			
Home security system / cameras			

Vehicles

Vehicle	Fuel level target	Get-home bag?	Notes
		☐	
		☐	

Section 6 — Roles & Team Coordination

Purpose: Everyone knows their job, and every section has an owner — with an alternate so the plan survives one person being unavailable.

Owner: _____ Alternate: _____

Household roles

Area	Person responsible	Alternate
Water		
Food & cooking		
Medical		
Power & fuel		
Comms & check-ins		
Kids / pets		
Property & security		
Rally point / evac lead		

Mutual aid network — the neighbors and suppliers who can help in a pinch, and who you can help.

Name	What they can help with	Phone / contact
Neighbor		
Neighbor		
Vet / large-animal vet		
Feed / supply dealer		
Equipment / parts dealer		
Other		

Team / extended family

Member	Role	Contact	Where they are in a crisis

Section 7 — Crisis Quick-Reference

Purpose: Think through each scenario before it happens, so the household reacts instead of freezes.

Owner: _____ Alternate: _____

One card per scenario. Fill in your household's specifics. For location-specific guidance, use FEMA's hazard information sheets and Ready.gov's Make a Plan materials (links on the Sources page).

Grid Failure

Before it happens:

- Know your backup heat and power options and their fuel
- Decide which devices and appliances are essential
- Have battery/crank lighting where you'll need it

When it's active, your household will:

- **Keep refrigerators and freezers closed** to hold the cold
- **Turn on battery/crank lighting**, not open flames, unless supervised
- **Check in via the comms plan** (Section 2) at the agreed time
- **Protect water** if pumps need power

Who you check on first: _____ What could run short: _____

Winter Storm

Before it happens:

- Confirm heat source works and fuel is full
- Prevent pipe freezing — know how you'll keep the house above freezing
- Have warm layers and blankets accessible per person

When it's active: keep one room warm, drip faucets if pipes are at risk, and stay off roads unless you must travel.

Who you check on first: _____ What could run short: _____

Wildfire

Before it happens:

- Know two evacuation routes out of your area
- Pack go-bags where they can be grabbed fast
- Know your rally point and out-of-area contact

When it's active: **leave early when advised** — do not wait for a second warning; grab the go-bags and binder copy, and check in with the out-of-area contact.

First alert to act on: _____ Evacuation trigger: _____

Water Crisis

Before it happens:

- Stored water is refreshed on the calendar
- Filtration/purification method works — tested
- Know where a backup source is (Section 4)

When it's active: use stored water first, then a tested backup source, and treat water before drinking if you're not certain of it.

What you'd ration first: _____ Backup source: _____

Supply Chain Shock

Before it happens:

- Pantry holds your food-day target (Section 5)
- Medications have a 30-day buffer where possible

- Cash on hand for outages at retailers

When it's active: avoid hoarding, rotate through what you have, and help neighbors where you can.

What runs out first in your household: _____

Pandemic

Before it happens:

- Household plan for two weeks of isolation — food, meds, hygiene
- Who checks on elderly or at-risk neighbors

When it's active: follow current public-health guidance from official sources, keep the household's medication and food buffer intact, and keep a calm, practical routine.

Household isolation plan: _____

Economic Collapse

Before it happens:

- Cash buffer in small bills (Section 8)
- Stocks of essentials reduce dependence on daily purchases
- Skills and barterable items identified

When it's active: avoid panic buying, use existing stock, and lean on the mutual aid network (Section 6).

First financial action your household takes: _____

EMP / Solar Flare

Before it happens:

- Understand what's vulnerable (electronics) and what isn't (mechanical, paper)
- The paper binder is your primary plan — this is exactly why
- Faraday-type storage considered for backup devices

When it's active: expect prolonged loss of electronics and grid services; fall back to the paper binder, radios, and manual tools.

What's protected vs. not: _____

Nuclear / Chemical Incident

Before it happens:

- Know the shelter-in-place room and its supplies (water, food, tape, plastic)
- Know official alert channels (weather radio, local alerts)

When it's active: follow official instructions — shelter in place or evacuate as directed, and do not improvise beyond your plan.

Shelter-in-place room: _____ Supplies staged there: _____

Section 8 — Financial & Legal Records

Purpose: Know your accounts, policies, and documents — and where the originals live — so the household can act on money and paperwork under stress.

Owner: _____ Alternate: _____

Financial institutions

Institution	Account(s)	Contact	Account # (or last 4)
Bank / credit union			
Credit cards			
Loans / mortgage			
Investments / retirement			
Safe-deposit box			Location:

Insurance policies

Policy	Company	Policy #	What it covers	Agent / claims #
Home / renters				
Auto				
Health				
Life				
Flood / disaster				
Livestock / farm				

Cash & liquidity

Item	Where	Notes
Emergency cash (small bills)		
Spare card		

Legal documents

Document	Have it?	Location of original	Signed / current?
Will	☐		

Document	Have it?	Location of original	Signed / current?
Durable power of attorney	☐		
Advance medical directive	☐		
Guardianship (children)	☐		
Trust documents	☐		
Deed / lease	☐		
Vehicle titles	☐		

Section 9 — Digital Backup & Security

Purpose: Make a second, encrypted copy of this binder that isn't the only copy, isn't readable by anyone who finds it, and isn't dependent on the cloud.

Owner: _____ Alternate: _____

Why the digital copy matters

The paper binder is your primary copy. The digital copy is your backup. Sensitive-document guidance from authoritative sources supports a specific approach:

- Keep a local copy of important data — data that exists **only** in the cloud can be lost (CISA).
- For physical backups, use an **encrypted external drive**; if you use cloud storage, **encrypt files before uploading** (California Privacy Protection Agency, April 2026).
- Encrypt before uploading, and be aware that cloud providers may be able to access customer data and that privacy terms can be unclear (HKCERT).
- Store an **encrypted thumb drive** in a filing cabinet, safe, or go-bag — cloud storage always carries some risk because files sit on someone else's server (PIRG).
- A disaster binder's **digital backup should be encrypted and password-protected** (FEEA).

The rule in practice: 3-2-1

- **3** copies of the binder — paper, encrypted drive A, encrypted drive B
- **2** formats — print and digital
- **1** copy off-site — in the go-bag, safe, or outbuilding

Your digital backup worksheet

Field	Details
Encrypted drive A (home)	Location:
Encrypted drive B (off-site)	Location:
Encryption method / tool	

Field	Details
Password manager used	
When was the last backup made?	Date:
When is the next backup due?	Date:

Do: encrypt before it leaves your hands, keep the password in your password manager, and re-back up after every update to the binder.

Don't: keep this binder's digital copy **only** in an online account.

What this has to do with PrepVault

PrepVault is built on the same principle: your preparedness plan, **encrypted and offline by default**, with cloud sync only if you turn it on. Your data stays on your device unless you choose otherwise — zero telemetry, no data selling. The binder is the plan on paper; PrepVault keeps the same plan live — inventory, expiry dates, and a real readiness score — on the devices you already carry.

Section 10 — Update Log

Purpose: Keep the binder alive. Review quarterly — and within a week of any move, medical change, major purchase, or near-miss.

Owner: _____ Alternate: _____

Quarterly review checklist

- Roster, contacts, and out-of-area contact are current
- Medications and medical worksheet updated
- Expiry dates checked and rotated (first in, first out)
- Stored water refreshed
- Fuel stabilized and full
- Digital backup re-created (Section 9)
- Everyone still knows where the binder lives

Date	What changed	Reviewed by

Keep this binder alive

The binder is your plan on paper. PrepVault keeps the same plan live on your devices — encrypted, fully offline, with no cloud dependency unless you choose it.

PrepVault tracks what this binder tracks, live:

- A real **Preparedness Score** — CRITICAL to FORTIFIED — based on your actual property, climate zone, and household
- **Continuity numbers you can act on**: power hours, water days, heat days, food days
- **Expiry tracking and rotation** so nothing silently goes bad in the back of the pantry
- **12 crisis scenario simulations** that show where your plan has gaps before it matters
- **Team coordination** — shared inventory, comms check-ins, and supply/trade offers with the people you trust

- **Crisis Mode** — a calm, step-by-step dashboard the moment something is actually happening

Fill in the paper binder once. Keep the live picture in PrepVault. When something changes, update both.

Get PrepVault free — run it offline, encrypted, no account required to start: **https://prepvault-xi.vercel.app**

PrepVault is not affiliated with, authorized by, or endorsed by FEMA, the U.S. Government, or the American Red Cross.

Sources & attribution

Planning backbone (referenced, not reproduced). This workbook paraphrases and links to government planning structure rather than reproducing it, per FEMA's reproduction terms.

- FEMA / Ready.gov — Make a Plan: https://www.ready.gov/plan
- FEMA / Ready.gov — Build a Kit: https://www.ready.gov/kit
- American Red Cross — Make a Plan: https://www.redcross.org/get-help/how-to-prepare-for-emergencies/make-a-plan.html

Sensitive-document security (Section 9)

- CISA — cloud storage risk guidance: https://www.cisa.gov/resources-tools/training/get-most-out-cloud-storage-and-services-while-minimizing-risk
- California Privacy Protection Agency — "Safely and Securely Back Up Your Data" (April 2026): https://privacy.ca.gov/2026/04/safely-and-securely-back-up-your-data-blog
- HKCERT — cloud storage security guideline: https://www.hkcert.org/security-guideline/cloud-storage-security
- PIRG — "Disaster-Proof Your Documents": https://pirg.org/edfund/resources/disaster-proof-documents
- FEEA — Disaster Preparedness Binder comprehensive guide: https://feea.org/2023/08/disaster-preparedness-binder-comprehensive-guide

Product

- PrepVault repository: https://github.com/Templecrash/PrepVault
- PrepVault app (deployed): https://prepvault-xi.vercel.app